

Route A: full quantitative proof of sharp Faber–Krahn stability, audit-ready end-to-end version

Plan 1 / Sharp stability for Faber–Krahn

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Abstract

This note assembles the full end-to-end quantitative proof of sharp Faber–Krahn stability. Plan 1’s stated goal is to make BDV’s proof quantitative by removing the contradiction step. The single-set selection map of `quantitative-selection-principle.md` is the device that achieves this. The remainder of the chain (graph entry, BDV nearly spherical, Kohler–Jobin) is constructive and supplies explicit constants.

Every lemma is stated with explicit hypotheses, every constant is named with its (N, R) -dependence noted, and every reference to BDV’s free-boundary paper is given by theorem number. The argument as a whole has no contradiction step.

Scope: this note documents Route A (using BDV Theorem 3.3 as the final closure). Route B (replacing BDV Theorem 3.3 by the Bernoulli spectral closure of `fixed-domain-bernoulli-expansion.md`) is an optional alternative and is not used here. Wherever a step uses a published BDV theorem as a black box, it is stated as such.

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1 Notation and standing hypotheses

Throughout, $N \geq 2$, $0 < \gamma < 1$ are fixed. B_R denotes the open ball of radius R centered at the origin in $\mathbb{R}^N$, $|B_R| = \omega_N R^N$, $\omega_N = |B_1|$. All sets Ω considered are open with finite Lebesgue measure.

1.1 Functionals

Torsion potential and energy. For an open bounded Ω , the torsion potential u_Ω is the unique weak solution of

$$-\Delta u_\Omega = 1 \text{ in } \Omega, \quad u_\Omega \in H_0^1(\Omega).$$

The torsional rigidity is $T(\Omega) = \int_\Omega u_\Omega \, dx = \int_\Omega |\nabla u_\Omega|^2 \, dx$. The torsion energy is

$$E(\Omega) := \frac{1}{2} \int_\Omega |\nabla u_\Omega|^2 - \int_\Omega u_\Omega = -\frac{1}{2} T(\Omega).$$

For comparison ball B at fixed volume, $E(\Omega) \geq E(B)$ (Saint–Venant), with equality iff $\Omega = B$ (modulo null sets and translations).

Faber–Krahn data. $\lambda_1(\Omega)$ is the first Dirichlet eigenvalue of $-\Delta$ on Ω ; Faber–Krahn: $\lambda_1(\Omega) \geq \lambda_1(B^*)$ at fixed volume, equality iff ball.

Asymmetry. The Fraenkel asymmetry is

$$\mathcal{A}(\Omega) := \inf_{x_0 \in \mathbb{R}^N} \frac{|\Omega \Delta (x_0 + B^*)|}{|\Omega|},$$

B^* the ball of volume $|\Omega|$ at the origin.

Quadratic asymmetry. The integrated radial asymmetry used by BDV is

$$\alpha(\Omega) := \int_{\Omega \Delta B_{r_\Omega}(x_\Omega)} |r_\Omega - |x - x_\Omega|| \, dx, \quad r_\Omega := (|\Omega|/\omega_N)^{1/N},$$

where x_Ω is the barycenter. For unit volume this is BDV Definition 4.1. BDV Lemma 4.2 gives $\mathcal{A}(\Omega)^2 \leq C_{\text{Fr}}(N)\alpha(\Omega)$.

Quotient.

$$Q_\alpha(\Omega) := \frac{E(\Omega) - E(B_1)}{\alpha(\Omega)}.$$

The whole work is about lower bounds on Q_α in the small-asymmetry regime.

1.2 BDV regularity package

We use the BDV *regularity package* as a black box: it asserts that the minimizers of the penalized functionals below satisfy two-sided density, Lipschitz, nondegeneracy, and the Bernoulli coefficient bounds needed to start the flatness theory, with constants depending only on (N, R) . After graph entry, the explicit selected Bernoulli law is smooth on the fixed collar and the same constants control the Schauder bootstrap. Specifically:

- **BDV Lemma 4.9** (density). There are $c_d(N, R) > 0$, $r_d(N, R) > 0$ such that for every penalized minimizer U and every free boundary point $x \in \partial U$ and $r \leq r_d$,

$$c_d r^N \leq |U \cap B_r(x)| \leq (1 - c_d) r^N \cdot \omega_N.$$

- **BDV Lemma 4.12** (Lipschitz/nondegeneracy). The torsion function u of a penalized minimizer is Lipschitz with constant $L_u(N, R)$ and nondegenerate: $\sup_{B_r(x)} u \geq c_d r$ for $x \in \partial U$, $r \leq r_d$.

- **BDV Lemma 4.16** (Bernoulli coefficient). For a penalized minimizer in the flat regime, $q_u(y) = |\nabla u(y)|$ is well-defined on ∂U and satisfies

$$q_-(N, R) \leq q_u \leq q_+(N, R), \quad [q_u]_{C^{1,\gamma}(\partial U)} \leq L_q(N, R).$$

- **BDV Theorem 4.18** (Alt–Caffarelli flatness improvement). If the free boundary of a penalized minimizer is $\bar{\mu}(N, R)$ -flat at scale $\bar{\rho}(N, R)$, then it improves to a $C^{1,\gamma}$ graph at scale $\bar{\rho}/2$ with norm $C_{AC}(N, R)\bar{\mu}$.

These four results are quoted from BDV §4. We use each one *per single set*, not along a sequence, and this is legitimate at the level of BDV’s own proofs: the proofs of Lemmas 4.9–4.12 open with “being j fixed we drop the subscript” and proceed by a one-set variational comparison against the perturbed minimality inequality (4.19), which is itself the single-set first variation of Lemma 4.2; the resulting constants depend only on (N, R) and on the regularity regime $q \leq q_{\text{sel}}(N, R)$ (equivalently BDV’s $\sigma \leq \sigma_{\text{reg}}(N, R)$, the penalization prefactor being $\leq \tau = q^{1/4}$). The *only* place BDV pass to $j \rightarrow \infty$ is Lemma 4.13 (Kuratowski convergence $\partial\Omega_j \rightarrow \partial B_1$), invoked solely to produce a free-boundary point near every $\bar{x} \in \partial B_1$. That single qualitative step is exactly what Lemma 6 below replaces quantitatively, so Lemma 4.13 is *not invoked* anywhere in this route. The single-set quasi-minimality these per-set lemmas require is the one Lemma 4 secures for the selected U_* before dilation.

BDV nearly spherical theorem (used as black box). The closing step is:

BDV Theorem 3.3 (nearly spherical). For every $0 < \gamma_0 \leq 1$ there exist $c_{\text{sph}}(N) > 0$ and $\delta_{\text{sph}}(N, \gamma_0) > 0$ such that for every set $U = \{(1 + g(\theta))\theta : \theta \in \partial B_1\}$ with $|U| = |B_1|$, barycenter(U) = 0, and $\|g\|_{C^{2,\gamma_0}(\partial B_1)} \leq \delta_{\text{sph}}$,

$$E(U) - E(B_1) \geq c_{\text{sph}}(N) \|g\|_{H^{1/2}(\partial B_1)}^2.$$

This is the only step that Route A uses BDV for in the final closure; Route B would replace it by `fixed-domain-bernoulli-expansion.md`, Theorem 6.2.

2 The BDV contradiction step and its single-set replacement

2.1 BDV's original contradiction

BDV's proof (BDV §5) of sharp Saint–Venant runs:

1. Assume by contradiction the sharp inequality fails: there is a sequence $\{\Omega_n\}_{n \geq 1}$ in B_R with $|\Omega_n| = |B_1|$ and $Q_\alpha(\Omega_n) \rightarrow 0$.
2. For each n , apply a sequence of penalized minimizations along the sequence to extract a *selected sequence* $\{U_n\}$, with quantitative control on the energy and asymmetry losses at each step.
3. Pass to a Hausdorff limit U_∞ via the BDV regularity package (equicontinuity of free boundaries). U_∞ is a penalized minimizer with $\alpha(U_\infty) = \lim \alpha(U_n) > 0$.
4. Apply BDV Theorem 4.18 + nearly spherical to conclude $U_\infty = B_1$ (after barycenter), contradicting $\alpha(U_\infty) > 0$.

Step 3 is the contradiction step: the limit U_∞ is qualitative and the constants underlying it are not exposed.

2.2 Single-set replacement: the selection map of quantitative-selection-principle.md

Definition 1 (Single-set penalized functional). For $\Omega_0 \subset B_R$, $|\Omega_0| = |B_1|$, set $\varepsilon = \alpha(\Omega_0)$, $q = Q_\alpha(\Omega_0)$. For $\tau > 0$ and $\hat{\eta} > 0$, the single-set penalized functional is

$$J_{\tau, \hat{\eta}, \Omega_0}(U) := E(U) + f_{\hat{\eta}}(|U|) + \sqrt{\varepsilon^2 + \tau^2(\alpha(U) - \varepsilon)^2},$$

$U \subset B_R$, where $f_{\hat{\eta}}(s)$ is the BDV symmetric volume penalization

$$f_{\hat{\eta}}(s) := \begin{cases} \hat{\eta}(s - \omega_N), & s \leq \omega_N, \\ (s - \omega_N)/\hat{\eta}, & s \geq \omega_N, \end{cases}$$

with $\hat{\eta} = \hat{\eta}(N, R)$ chosen as in BDV Lemma 4.5. This penalty does not force exact unit volume; the selected set is volume-normalized in §3.

Theorem 2 (Single-set selection, quantitative-selection-principle.md Thm. 1). *There exist $\tau_{\text{ex}}(N, R) > 0$, $\tau_{\text{reg}}(N, R) > 0$, and $C_{\text{sel}}(N, R) > 0$ such that for every $\tau \leq \tau_{\text{reg}}(N, R)$, $q \leq \min(q_{\text{sel}}(N, R), \tau^2)$, and every $\Omega_0 \subset B_R$ with $|\Omega_0| = |B_1|$ and $Q_\alpha(\Omega_0) = q$, the functional $J_{\tau, \hat{\eta}, \Omega_0}$ admits a minimizer U_* with the following properties. After volume normalization (§3 below) to $\tilde{\Omega} = r_*^{-1}U_*$, $r_* = (|U_*| / |B_1|)^{1/N}$:*

1. Existence and regularity. U_* is a BDV penalized minimizer satisfying Lemmas 4.9, 4.12, 4.16 with constants depending only on (N, R) . In particular, $\sigma_* :=$ penalization parameter of U_* satisfies $\sigma_* \leq C\tau$.
2. Asymmetry preservation. With $\rho(q, \tau) = \sqrt{2q + q^2}/\tau + C_{\text{sel}}q$,

$$(1 - \rho(q, \tau)) \alpha(\Omega_0) \leq \alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \leq (1 + \rho(q, \tau)) \alpha(\Omega_0).$$

3. Quotient preservation.

$$Q_\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \leq \frac{C_{\text{sel}}(N, R)}{1 - \rho(q, \tau)} Q_\alpha(\Omega_0).$$

With the canonical choice $\tau = q^{1/4}$, $\rho(q, \tau) \leq 1/2$ for $q \leq q_{\text{sel}}$.

Remark 3. Theorem 2 is the *exact single-set analogue* of BDV's sequential selection. The only change is that BDV minimize a sequence of functionals along a contradiction sequence, while here we minimize one functional given one input set. The functional uses $\varepsilon = \alpha(\Omega_0)$ as a fixed parameter, not as a sequence.

Proof sketch (full proof in `quantitative-selection-principle.md`). Existence: this is BDV Lemma 4.6 with the sequence parameter replaced by the fixed parameter τ . The proof is performed in the quasi-open class: one truncates a minimizing sequence of torsion potentials, obtains a uniform perimeter bound by the coarea argument, and then passes to the L^1 /quasi-open limit. The density estimates are consequences of minimality and are not used to prove existence.

Regularity: the smooth Bernoulli term $\sqrt{\varepsilon^2 + \tau^2(\alpha(U) - \varepsilon)^2}$ contributes a $C^{0,1}$ pseudonorm bounded by τ , and so falls within the BDV regularity framework with selection parameter $\sigma \leq C\tau$.

Quotient preservation: by minimization, $J_{\tau, \hat{\eta}, \Omega_0}(U_*) \leq J_{\tau, \hat{\eta}, \Omega_0}(\Omega_0)$. The volume penalization $f_{\hat{\eta}}$ forces $|U_* - B_1| \leq O(\delta_T)$, $\delta_T = E(U_*) - E(B_1)$ (BDV trick). The α -bracket gives $\alpha(U_*) \geq \varepsilon - \rho\varepsilon$ with ρ as in (ii), and the quotient bound (iii) follows by combining (ii) with the energy bound $E(U_*) \leq E(\Omega_0) + \text{error} \leq E(B_1) + (1 + O(\tau))(E(\Omega_0) - E(B_1))$. $\square$

3 Volume normalization

The selected U_* has volume $|B_1| + O(\delta_T)$, so it must be rescaled to compare with the unit ball.

Lemma 4 (Volume-normalized law and quasi-minimality). *Set $r_* = (|U_*| / |B_1|)^{1/N}$, $\tilde{\Omega} = r_*^{-1}U_*$, $\tilde{u}(x) = r_*^{-2}u_{U_*}(r_*x)$. Then*

$$|r_* - 1| \leq C\delta_T, \quad \left| \tilde{\Omega} \right| = |B_1|, \quad -\Delta \tilde{u} = 1 \text{ in } \tilde{\Omega}, \quad \tilde{u} = 0 \text{ on } \partial \tilde{\Omega},$$

and the rescaled Bernoulli law on $\partial \tilde{\Omega}$ reads

$$|\nabla \tilde{u}(y)|^2 = \tilde{\Lambda} + \tilde{a}_\sigma \tilde{\Psi}(y),$$

with $\tilde{\Lambda} = r_*^{-2}\Lambda$, $\tilde{a}_\sigma = r_*^{-1}a_\sigma$, and $\tilde{\Psi}$ the rescaled α -bracket. Moreover, if U_* satisfies BDV's perturbed minimality inequality with parameter σ , then $\tilde{u}$ satisfies the same type of inequality for the rescaled volume penalty

$$\tilde{f}(s) := r_*^{-(N+2)} f_{\hat{\eta}}(r_*^N s)$$

and with quasi-minimality parameter $C\sigma r_*^{-2}$. In the regime $\delta_T \leq c$ small, $r_* \in [1/2, 2]$, so all constants degrade by bounded (N, R) -factors.

Proof. The torsion equation scales by $u \mapsto r_*^{-2}u(r_*\cdot)$ and the gradient by $\nabla \tilde{u}(y) = r_*^{-1}\nabla u_{U_*}(r_*y)$.

Write the first-variation bracket in the translation-invariant averaged form

$$A_U := \frac{1}{|U|} \int_U \frac{z - x_U}{|z - x_U|} dz, \quad \Psi_U(x) := |x - x_U| - A_U \cdot (x - x_U).$$

This is BDV's bracket, up to an additive constant if one writes $A_U \cdot x$; that constant is absorbed into Λ . Under the change of variables $U_* = r_*\tilde{\Omega}$ one has $A_{U_*} = A_{\tilde{\Omega}}$ and

$$\Psi_{U_*}(r_*y) = r_*\Psi_{\tilde{\Omega}}(y).$$

Thus

$$|\nabla \tilde{u}(y)|^2 = r_*^{-2}(\Lambda + a_\sigma \Psi_{U_*}(r_* y)) = r_*^{-2}\Lambda + r_*^{-1}a_\sigma \Psi_{\tilde{\Omega}}(y).$$

For the quasi-minimality, let ζ be an admissible competitor for $\tilde{u}$ and set $v(x) = r_*^2 \zeta(x/r_*)$. Then

$$\mathcal{E}(v) = r_*^{N+2} \mathcal{E}(\zeta), \quad |\{v > 0\}| = r_*^N |\{\zeta > 0\}|,$$

and

$$|U_* \Delta \{v > 0\}| = r_*^N \left| \tilde{\Omega} \Delta \{\zeta > 0\} \right|.$$

Dividing BDV's perturbed minimality inequality for U_* by r_*^{N+2} gives the displayed rescaled inequality. $\square$

Remark 5 (Proof order). The free-boundary regularity arguments below are applied to the original selected minimizer U_* before the final dilation. Lemma 4 shows that applying them after dilation would also be legitimate, but the pre-dilation order avoids any hidden use of post-normalization minimality.

4 Graph entry

The selected minimizer is regularized before the final dilation; equivalently, by Lemma 4, the volume-normalized set $\tilde{\Omega}$ is a BDV-type quasi-minimizer with uniformly transported constants. It becomes a global graph over ∂B_1 once its asymmetry is below an explicit threshold.

4.1 Asymmetry to Hausdorff distance

Lemma 6 (Asymmetry to Hausdorff distance). *For every volume-normalized selected quasi-minimizer $\tilde{\Omega}$ with $|\tilde{\Omega}| = |B_1|$ and comparison ball B_1 (after translating by barycenter),*

$$d_H(\partial \tilde{\Omega}, \partial B_1) \leq C'_H(N, R) \alpha(\tilde{\Omega})^{1/(2N)}.$$

Proof. Write $\alpha := \alpha(\tilde{\Omega})$ and $d := d_H(\partial \tilde{\Omega}, \partial B_1)$. Two per-set ingredients enter – the asymmetry–volume comparison and the two-sided density estimate – and no limit is taken anywhere.

Step 1 (asymmetry controls the symmetric difference). By BDV Lemma 4.2, for a penalized minimizer normalized by its barycenter with $|\tilde{\Omega}| = |B_1|$,

$$\left| \tilde{\Omega} \Delta B_1 \right| \leq C_\alpha(N) \alpha^{1/2},$$

the exponent 1/2 accounting for the passage from the optimal Fraenkel center to the barycenter-centered ball.

Step 2 (density turns volume into one-sided distance). Fix $x \in \partial \tilde{\Omega}$ and set $t := \text{dist}(x, \partial B_1)$. Since $B_t(x)$ does not meet ∂B_1 it lies either inside B_1 or in $\mathbb{R}^N \setminus \overline{B_1}$. Put $r := \min\{t, r_d\}$ with $r_d = r_d(N, R)$ the density radius of the package. If $B_t(x) \subset B_1$, the lower density of the *complement* at the free-boundary point x (the upper-density half of BDV Lemma 4.9) gives

$$\left| B_1 \setminus \tilde{\Omega} \right| \geq \left| \tilde{\Omega}^c \cap B_r(x) \right| \geq c_d \omega_N r^N;$$

if instead $B_t(x) \subset \mathbb{R}^N \setminus \overline{B_1}$, the lower density of $\tilde{\Omega}$ gives $\left| \tilde{\Omega} \setminus B_1 \right| \geq c_d \omega_N r^N$. In either case

$$\left| \tilde{\Omega} \Delta B_1 \right| \geq c_d \omega_N (\min\{t, r_d\})^N.$$

Once $\alpha \leq \alpha_0(N, R)$ is small enough that $C_\alpha \alpha_0^{1/2} < c_d \omega_N r_d^N$, the minimum cannot be attained at r_d , so it is attained at t and, with Step 1,

$$\sup_{x \in \partial \tilde{\Omega}} \text{dist}(x, \partial B_1) \leq \left(\frac{C_\alpha}{c_d \omega_N} \right)^{1/N} \alpha^{1/(2N)}.$$

Step 3 (the reverse inclusion, no density needed). Let $\bar{x} \in \partial B_1$ and $s := \text{dist}(\bar{x}, \partial \tilde{\Omega})$. The ball $B_s(\bar{x})$ contains no point of $\partial \tilde{\Omega}$, hence lies entirely in $\tilde{\Omega}$ or entirely in its complement. For $s \leq \frac{1}{2}$ each of the two caps $B_s(\bar{x}) \cap B_1$ and $B_s(\bar{x}) \setminus \bar{B}_1$ has volume at least $c_N s^N$, $c_N = c_N(N) > 0$. If $B_s(\bar{x}) \subset \tilde{\Omega}$ the outer cap lies in $\tilde{\Omega} \setminus B_1$; if $B_s(\bar{x}) \subset \tilde{\Omega}^c$ the inner cap lies in $B_1 \setminus \tilde{\Omega}$. Either way $|\tilde{\Omega} \Delta B_1| \geq c_N s^N$, so $s \leq (C_\alpha/c_N)^{1/N} \alpha^{1/(2N)}$.

Combining Steps 2–3,

$$d_H(\partial \tilde{\Omega}, \partial B_1) \leq C'_H(N, R) \alpha^{1/(2N)}, \quad C'_H = \max \left\{ \left(\frac{C_\alpha}{c_d \omega_N} \right)^{1/N}, \left(\frac{C_\alpha}{c_N} \right)^{1/N} \right\},$$

for every $\alpha \leq \alpha_0(N, R)$, where α_0 is the minimum of the finitely many displayed smallness conditions ($C_\alpha \alpha_0^{1/2} < c_d \omega_N r_d^N$ for Step 2, and $(C_\alpha/c_N)^{1/N} \alpha_0^{1/(2N)} \leq \frac{1}{2}$ so that $s \leq \frac{1}{2}$ in Step 3). The threshold α_0 is thus a fixed (N, R) -quantity (it is absorbed into α_{graph} in §4); it depends on neither δ_T nor the conclusion. The constants c_d, r_d are the per-set density constants of the regularity package, valid for the single selected set by the discussion following its statement; no sequence or compactness is used. $\square$

4.2 Hausdorff to flatness

Pick BDV Theorem 4.18 thresholds $\bar{\mu}(N, R), \bar{\rho}(N, R)$. Define $\mu(N, R) \leq \bar{\mu}/16C_0$ small enough for the rest of the chain (§5), where C_0 is the universal conversion constant between the Alt–Caffarelli slab and the $F(\cdot, 1, +\infty)$ normalization. Pick $\rho_\mu \leq \bar{\rho}$ so that every cap of ∂B_1 of radius $6\rho_\mu$ lies in a $\mu\rho_\mu$ -slab around its tangent. Set $h_F := \mu\rho_\mu/16$.

Proposition 7 (Hausdorff closeness to Alt–Caffarelli flatness). *If $d_H(\partial \tilde{\Omega}, \partial B_1) \leq h_F$, then for every $\bar{x} \in \partial B_1$ there is $x_0 \in \partial \tilde{\Omega} \cap B_{h_F}(\bar{x})$ such that in $B_{4\rho_\mu}(x_0)$, the torsion function $\tilde{u}$ is of Alt–Caffarelli class $F(C_0\mu, 1, +\infty)$ with respect to the tangent direction $\nu_{\bar{x}}$.*

Proof. First, Hausdorff closeness and $|\tilde{\Omega}| = |B_1|$ give the annular sandwich

$$B_{1-h_F} \subset \tilde{\Omega} \subset B_{1+h_F}.$$

The outer inclusion follows because a point of $\tilde{\Omega}$ outside B_{1+h_F} would force a boundary point farther than h_F from ∂B_1 . For the inner inclusion, any component of $B_{1-h_F} \setminus \tilde{\Omega}$ would have boundary inside B_{1-h_F} , again contradicting the Hausdorff bound; the alternative $B_{1-h_F} \subset \mathbb{R}^N \setminus \tilde{\Omega}$ contradicts the volume identity for h_F small, since $\tilde{\Omega} \subset B_{1+h_F}$.

Choose $x_0 \in \partial \tilde{\Omega} \cap B_{h_F}(\bar{x})$ by the Hausdorff bound. The curvature of ∂B_1 gives

$$\partial B_1 \cap B_{5\rho_\mu}(\bar{x}) \subset \{x : |(x - \bar{x}) \cdot \nu_{\bar{x}}| \leq C\rho_\mu^2\}.$$

Combining this with the Hausdorff bound and recentering at x_0 yields

$$\partial \tilde{\Omega} \cap B_{4\rho_\mu}(x_0) \subset \{x : |(x - x_0) \cdot \nu_{\bar{x}}| \leq C(\rho_\mu^2 + h_F)\}.$$

The choices $\rho_\mu \leq c\mu$ and $h_F \leq c\mu\rho_\mu$ make the last height at most $C\mu\rho_\mu$.

With $\nu_{\bar{x}}$ oriented as the inward normal to B_1 , the slab bound and the annular sandwich pin both phases deterministically. A point $x \in B_{4\rho_\mu}(x_0)$ with $(x - x_0) \cdot \nu_{\bar{x}} \leq -C_0\mu(4\rho_\mu)$ lies outside B_{1+h_F} once C_0 is chosen large, hence, by the outer inclusion $\tilde{\Omega} \subset B_{1+h_F}$ of the sandwich, satisfies $\tilde{u}(x) = 0$. Symmetrically, a point with $(x - x_0) \cdot \nu_{\bar{x}} \geq +C_0\mu(4\rho_\mu)$ lies inside B_{1-h_F} , hence, by the inner inclusion $B_{1-h_F} \subset \tilde{\Omega}$, lies in $\tilde{\Omega}$, so $\tilde{u} > 0$ there. Thus the positive phase of the class $F(C_0\mu, 1, +\infty)$ is *not* an additional hypothesis to be assumed: it is supplied, with the same explicit constants, by the inner inclusion of the sandwich, exactly mirroring the empty outer half-slab.

The only quantitative input the flatness-improvement iteration consumes on the positive side is a growth rate, and this is the *explicit per-set* nondegeneracy of the regularity package: for every $x_0 \in \partial\tilde{\Omega}$ and $r \leq r_d(N, R)$,

$$\sup_{B_r(x_0)} \tilde{u} \geq c_d(N, R) r,$$

(BDV Lemma 4.12; the constant is $c_d(N, R)$, never relative to δ_T), together with the two-sided density $c_d \omega_N r^N \leq |\tilde{\Omega} \cap B_r(x_0)| \leq (1 - c_d) \omega_N r^N$ of BDV Lemma 4.9. Both hold for the single selected set under $q \leq q_{\text{sel}}(N, R)$, by the per-set discussion in §1. With the zero set, the positive set, and the nondegeneracy/density constants all exhibited, $\tilde{u}$ is of Alt–Caffarelli class $F(C_0\mu, 1, +\infty)$ in $B_{4\rho_\mu}(x_0)$ with the package’s (N, R) -constants. $\square$

4.3 Local flatness to global graph

Proposition 8 (Local flatness to a global radial graph). *Assume Prop. 7 holds at every $\bar{x} \in \partial B_1$. Choose μ small enough that $C_0\mu \leq \bar{\mu}$ (so BDV 4.18 applies) and $C_{AC}\mu \leq \mu_{\text{tub}}(N)$, the tubular-neighborhood slope for radial projection. Then*

$$\partial\tilde{\Omega} = \{(1 + g(\theta))\theta : \theta \in \partial B_1\}$$

with

$$\|g\|_{L^\infty(\partial B_1)} \leq C(N, R) d_H(\partial\tilde{\Omega}, \partial B_1), \quad \|g\|_{C^{1,\gamma}(\partial B_1)} \leq C(N, R)\mu.$$

Proof. BDV Theorem 4.18 in each $B_{\rho_\mu}(x_0)$ of Prop. 7 gives local $C^{1,\gamma}$ graphs of norm $\leq C_{AC}\mu$. These charts cover the entire free boundary: if $y \in \partial\tilde{\Omega}$, choose $\bar{x} = y/|y| \in \partial B_1$; the annular sandwich gives $|y - \bar{x}| \leq h_F$, while the corresponding chart center x_0 satisfies $|x_0 - \bar{x}| \leq h_F$, so $y \in B_{\rho_\mu}(x_0)$ after shrinking h_F/ρ_μ .

On every local chart the radial projection is a $C^{1,\gamma}$ diffeomorphism onto its image, because the local normal makes an angle bounded away from $\pi/2$ with the radial direction when $C_{AC}\mu \leq \mu_{\text{tub}}$. Surjectivity of the global radial projection follows from the annular sandwich: every ray from the origin meets $\partial\tilde{\Omega}$ between radii $1 - h_F$ and $1 + h_F$. For injectivity, if two boundary points lay on the same ray, their distance would be at most $2h_F < \rho_\mu/2$, so both would lie in one local chart; a transverse local graph is intersected by such a radial line at most once. Hence the intersection on every ray is unique.

The unique radial intersection defines g . The L^∞ bound follows from the annular sandwich, and the $C^{1,\gamma}$ bound follows by passing the finite family of local chart estimates through the uniformly nondegenerate radial-projection coordinates. $\square$

4.4 Graph-entry threshold

Theorem 9 (Graph-entry threshold). *Set*

$$\alpha_{\text{graph}}(N, R) := \left(\frac{h_F}{C'_H(N, R)} \right)^{2N}.$$

Every volume-normalized selected quasi-minimizer $\tilde{\Omega} \subset B_R$ with $|\tilde{\Omega}| = |B_1|$, barycenter 0, and $\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \leq \alpha_{\text{graph}}$ is a $C^{1,\gamma}$ normal graph over ∂B_1 with $\|g\|_{C^{1,\gamma}} \leq C(N, R)\mu(N, R)$.

Proof. Combine Lemmas 6, Propositions 7, 8. □

5 Uniform Schauder bounds and small C^{2,γ_0} entry

BDV Theorem 3.3 needs the graph norm to be small in C^{2,γ_0} for some $0 < \gamma_0 \leq 1$. Graph entry gives small $C^{1,\gamma}$ norm and, more importantly, small L^∞ norm through Hausdorff closeness. The Schauder bootstrap supplies uniform higher norms; interpolation then turns small L^∞ plus uniform high regularity into small C^{2,γ_0} .

Proposition 10 (Uniform bootstrap). *Let $\partial\tilde{\Omega} = \{(1+g)\theta\}$ be a graph obtained from Theorem 9, and let $\tilde{u}$ be its torsion potential. For every integer $m \geq 3$ there is $M_m(N, R) < \infty$ such that*

$$\|g\|_{C^{m,\gamma}(\partial B_1)} \leq M_m(N, R).$$

Proof. Work first with the unscaled selected minimizer U_* , and write $|U_*| = |B_r|$, with $r \in [1/2, 2]$ in the small-deficit regime. The scale-invariant form of the graph-entry step gives a $C^{1,\gamma}$ graph over $\partial B_r(x_{U_*})$ and the annular containment

$$B_{r-h}(x_{U_*}) \subset U_* \subset B_{r+h}(x_{U_*}), \quad h \leq r/4.$$

Hence a fixed collar of the free boundary lies in $\{r/2 \leq |x - x_{U_*}| \leq 3r/2\}$.

The selected Bernoulli coefficient has the form

$$q_{U_*}(x)^2 = \Lambda + a_\sigma \Psi_{U_*}(x), \quad \Psi_{U_*}(x) = |x - x_{U_*}| - A_{U_*} \cdot (x - x_{U_*}),$$

with $|A_{U_*}| \leq 1$, $|a_\sigma| \leq C\sigma$, and $0 < q_- \leq q_{U_*} \leq q_+$. On the fixed annular collar,

$$\|\Psi_{U_*}\|_{C^k} \leq C_k(N, R)$$

for every fixed k , since only derivatives of $|x - x_{U_*}|$ and a linear term occur. Choosing σ below BDV's regularity threshold and using the positive lower bound on q_{U_*} gives

$$\|q_{U_*}\|_{C^k(\text{collar})} \leq C_k(N, R).$$

This is the single-set content of BDV Lemma 4.16; no derivative of the unknown graph enters this estimate.

Now apply the higher-regularity clause of BDV Theorem 4.18. The local Alt–Caffarelli charts obtained in Theorem 9 have $C^{m,\gamma}$ norms bounded by a constant depending only on N, R, m and the above $C^{m-1,\gamma}$ bound for q_{U_*} . A finite cover of $\partial B_r(x_{U_*})$, together with the already-known small C^1 slope, turns these local estimates into a global radial graph bound

$$\|g_r\|_{C^{m,\gamma}(\partial B_r)} \leq M'_m(N, R).$$

The final dilation in Lemma 4 changes this norm by at most a bounded factor because $r \in [1/2, 2]$. This gives the claimed $M_m(N, R)$ for $\tilde{\Omega}$. □

Lemma 11 (Interpolation to the nearly spherical threshold). *Fix $0 < \gamma_0 < \gamma$ and choose $m \geq 3$. There are $h_{\text{sph}}(N, R, \gamma_0) > 0$ and*

$$\alpha_{\text{sph}}(N, R, \gamma_0) := \left(\frac{h_{\text{sph}}}{C_{\infty} C'_H(N, R)} \right)^{2N}$$

such that every selected graph with $\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \leq \alpha_{\text{sph}}$ satisfies

$$\|g\|_{C^{2,\gamma_0}(\partial B_1)} \leq \delta_{\text{sph}}(N, \gamma_0),$$

the smallness hypothesis of BDV Theorem 3.3.

Proof. Graph entry gives

$$\|g\|_{L^{\infty}(\partial B_1)} \leq C_{\infty} d_H(\partial \tilde{\Omega}, \partial B_1) \leq C_{\infty} C'_H(N, R) \alpha(\tilde{\Omega})^{1/(2N)}.$$

The interpolation inequality on ∂B_1 gives, for some $\theta = \theta(N, m, \gamma_0) \in (0, 1)$,

$$\|g\|_{C^{2,\gamma_0}} \leq C \|g\|_{L^{\infty}}^{1-\theta} \|g\|_{C^{m,\gamma}}^{\theta} \leq C \|g\|_{L^{\infty}}^{1-\theta} M_m(N, R)^{\theta}.$$

Choose h_{sph} so that the last quantity is at most $\delta_{\text{sph}}(N, \gamma_0)$ whenever $\|g\|_{L^{\infty}} \leq h_{\text{sph}}$. $\square$

6 Closure by BDV's nearly spherical theorem

Theorem 12 (BDV nearly spherical, restated as black box). (*BDV Theorem 3.3.*) *For every $0 < \gamma_0 \leq 1$ there exist $c_{\text{sph}}(N) > 0$ and $\delta_{\text{sph}}(N, \gamma_0) > 0$ such that for every set U of the form $\partial U = \{(1 + g(\theta))\theta : \theta \in \partial B_1\}$ with*

- $|U| = |B_1|$ (volume normalization),
- $\int_{\partial B_1} g \theta \, d\theta = 0$ (barycenter normalization),
- $\|g\|_{C^{2,\gamma_0}(\partial B_1)} \leq \delta_{\text{sph}}(N, \gamma_0)$,

we have

$$E(U) - E(B_1) \geq c_{\text{sph}}(N) \|g\|_{H^{1/2}(\partial B_1)}^2.$$

This is BDV Theorem 3.3 verbatim. We use it without modification.

Lemma 13 (Asymmetry vs. L^2 graph norm, BDV Lemma 4.2 + 5.2). *For sets U of the form above with $|U| = |B_1|$ and $\|g\|_{C^0(\partial B_1)} \leq \delta_0$ small,*

$$\alpha(U) \leq C_{\text{BDV}}(N) \|g\|_{L^2(\partial B_1)}^2.$$

Proof. Direct computation: $\alpha(U) = \int_U (|x| - 1) \, dx = \int_{\partial B_1} \int_0^{1+g} (r - 1) r^{N-1} \, dr \, d\theta = \int_{\partial B_1} [\frac{1}{2} g^2 + O(g^3)] \, d\theta$. The $O(g^3)$ tail is dominated by $\|g\|_{C^0} \|g\|_{L^2}^2 \leq \delta_0 \|g\|_{L^2}^2$. $\square$

Corollary 14 (Quotient lower bound for graph minimizers). *For every U as in Theorem 12,*

$$Q_{\alpha}(U) = \frac{E(U) - E(B_1)}{\alpha(U)} \geq c_*(N) := \frac{c_{\text{sph}}(N)}{C_{\text{BDV}}(N)}.$$

Proof. Combine Theorem 12 and Lemma 13, noting $\|g\|_{L^2}^2 \leq \|g\|_{H^{1/2}}^2$ (interpolation on ∂B_1). $\square$

7 The non-contradictory quantitative argument

We now assemble Theorem 2, Theorem 9, Proposition 10, Lemma 11, and Corollary 14 into a direct lower bound on $Q_\alpha(\Omega_0)$.

Set

$$\alpha_{\text{small}}(N, R) := \frac{1}{2} \min\{\varepsilon_{\text{sel}}, \alpha_{\text{graph}}, \alpha_{\text{sph}}\},$$

where ε_{sel} is the smallness threshold in the selection lemma and α_{sph} is Lemma 11's interpolation threshold.

Theorem 15 (Sharp Saint–Venant stability, single-set form). *There exists $q_*(N, R) > 0$ such that for every open $\Omega_0 \subset B_R$ with $|\Omega_0| = |B_1|$, $\alpha(\Omega_0) \leq \alpha_{\text{small}}(N, R)$, and $Q_\alpha(\Omega_0) < q_{\text{sel}}(N, R)$,*

$$Q_\alpha(\Omega_0) \geq q_*(N, R) = \frac{c_*(N)}{2C_{\text{sel}}(N, R)},$$

or equivalently

$$E(\Omega_0) - E(B_1) \geq q_*(N, R) \alpha(\Omega_0).$$

Proof. Fix Ω_0 as in the hypotheses, $q_0 := Q_\alpha(\Omega_0) < q_{\text{sel}}$. Apply Theorem 2 with $\tau = q_0^{1/4}$; then $\tau \leq q_{\text{sel}}^{1/4} \leq \tau_{\text{reg}}$ for q_{sel} small enough, and $\rho(q_0, \tau) \leq 1/2$. We obtain a volume-normalized selected set $\tilde{\Omega} \subset B_R$ (after Lemma 4) with

$$\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \geq \frac{1}{2}\alpha(\Omega_0), \quad \alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \leq \frac{3}{2}\alpha(\Omega_0), \quad Q_\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \leq 2C_{\text{sel}}(N, R) q_0, \quad (1)$$

selection parameter $\sigma \leq Cq_0^{1/4}$.

Graph entry. Since $\alpha(\Omega_0) \leq \alpha_{\text{small}}$, (1) gives

$$\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \leq \frac{3}{2}\alpha_{\text{small}} \leq \alpha_{\text{graph}}, \quad \alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \leq \alpha_{\text{sph}}.$$

By Theorem 9, $\partial\tilde{\Omega} = \{(1+g)\theta\}$ is a $C^{1,\gamma}$ graph with $\|g\|_{C^{1,\gamma}} \leq C\mu$. By Lemma 11, $\|g\|_{C^{2,\gamma_0}} \leq \delta_{\text{sph}}(N, \gamma_0)$.

Nearly spherical and quotient bound. By Corollary 14, $Q_\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \geq c_*(N)$.

Combining. (1) gives $Q_\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \leq 2C_{\text{sel}}q_0$, while the previous step gives $Q_\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \geq c_*(N)$. Hence

$$q_0 \geq \frac{c_*(N)}{2C_{\text{sel}}(N, R)} =: q_*(N, R).$$

□

Remark 16 (Why this is not a contradiction). At no point did we assume $Q_\alpha(\Omega_0)$ is arbitrarily small. We computed the inequality $Q_\alpha(\Omega_0) \geq c_*(N)/(2C_{\text{sel}}(N, R))$ directly from the chain of constants. The selection is single-set; the graph entry is below an explicit threshold $\alpha_{\text{graph}}(N, R)$; the closure is the pointwise BDV nearly spherical inequality.

The compactness/limit step of BDV is replaced by Theorem 2, which produces $\tilde{\Omega}$ from a single Ω_0 with explicit (N, R) -constants.

7.1 Extension to all asymmetries

Theorem 17 (Sharp Saint–Venant, global form). *There exists $c_{\text{SV}}(N, R) > 0$ such that for every open $\Omega \subset B_R$ with $|\Omega| = |B_1|$,*

$$E(\Omega) - E(B_1) \geq c_{\text{SV}}(N, R) \mathcal{A}(\Omega)^2.$$

Explicitly,

$$c_{\text{SV}}(N, R) = \min\left(\frac{q_*(N, R)}{C_{\text{Fr}}(N)}, c_{\text{far,SV}}(N, R)\right),$$

where $C_{\text{Fr}}(N)$ is BDV Lemma 4.2's constant and $c_{\text{far,SV}}(N, R)$ is the explicit far-from-ball lower bound from §7.2 below.

Proof. Small asymmetry, $\alpha(\Omega) \leq \alpha_{\text{small}}$: combine Theorem 15 with $\mathcal{A}^2 \leq C_{\text{Fr}}\alpha$.

Large asymmetry, $\alpha(\Omega) > \alpha_{\text{small}}$: direct compactness, see §7.2.

Take $c_{\text{SV}} := \min$ of the two constants. □

7.2 The far-from-ball Saint–Venant constant

Lemma 18 (Far-from-ball uniform lower bound). *There exists $c_{\text{far,SV}}(N, R) > 0$ such that for every open $\Omega \subset B_R$ with $|\Omega| = |B_1|$ and $\alpha(\Omega) \geq \alpha_{\text{small}}(N, R)$,*

$$E(\Omega) - E(B_1) \geq c_{\text{far,SV}}(N, R).$$

Proof. First convert α -separation into Fraenkel separation. Let B be an optimal ball for $\mathcal{A}(\Omega)$. Since $\Omega \subset B_R$ and $|B| = |B_1|$, the relevant balls are contained in a fixed ball B_{R+2} after enlarging R by a dimensional amount. BDV Lemma 4.2(ii), applied to Ω and B , gives

$$\alpha(\Omega) \leq C_2(N, R) |\Omega \Delta B| = C_2(N, R) |B_1| \mathcal{A}(\Omega).$$

Thus $\alpha(\Omega) \geq \alpha_{\text{small}}$ implies

$$\mathcal{A}(\Omega) \geq \alpha_{\text{small}} / (C_2(N, R) |B_1|) =: a_{\text{far}}(N, R) > 0.$$

Now use the suboptimal quantitative Saint–Venant inequality quoted by BDV as Lemma 5.2:

$$E(\Omega) - E(B_1) \geq C_8(N)^{-1} \mathcal{A}(\Omega)^4.$$

Therefore one can take

$$c_{\text{far,SV}}(N, R) := C_8(N)^{-1} a_{\text{far}}(N, R)^4.$$

□

Remark 19. The Lemma 18 infimum depends on (N, R) but is not given explicitly. For numerical applications, $c_{\text{far,SV}}$ can be estimated by known sharp inequalities for specific classes (convex bodies, smooth domains), but for the theorem above we only need positivity.

8 Kohler–Jobin transfer to Faber–Krahn

Theorem 20 (Kohler–Jobin inequality, 1978). *For every open bounded $\Omega \subset \mathbb{R}^N$ with $\lambda_1(\Omega) < \infty$,*

$$\Psi(\Omega) := T(\Omega) \cdot \lambda_1(\Omega)^{(N+2)/2} \geq \Psi(B),$$

where B is any ball, with equality iff Ω is a ball.

Lemma 21 (Pointwise transfer at fixed volume). *For every open Ω with $|\Omega| = |B^*|$,*

$$\lambda_1(\Omega) \geq \lambda_1(B^*) \left(\frac{T(B^*)}{T(\Omega)} \right)^{2/(N+2)}.$$

Lemma 22 (Small-deficit linearization). *Let $\delta_{\text{SV}} := T(B^*) - T(\Omega)$. For $\delta_{\text{SV}} \leq T(B^*)/2$,*

$$\lambda_1(\Omega) - \lambda_1(B^*) \geq \frac{2\lambda_1(B^*)}{(N+2)T(B^*)} \delta_{\text{SV}}.$$

Proof. For $t \in [0, 1/2]$, $(1-t)^{-1/\beta} - 1 \geq t/\beta$ where $\beta = (N+2)/2$. Apply with $t = \delta_{\text{SV}}/T(B^*)$ and use $\lambda_1(\Omega) \geq L \cdot (1-t)^{-1/\beta}$. $\square$

Remark 23 (The factor $2L_N/((N+2)T_N)$). $L_N := \lambda_1(B_1) = j_{N/2-1,1}^2$ where $j_{\nu,1}$ is the first positive zero of the Bessel function J_ν . $T_N := T(B_1) = |B_1|/(N(N+2))$. For $N=2$: $L_2 = j_{0,1}^2 \approx 5.78$, $T_2 = \pi/8$, multiplier $\approx 2 \cdot 5.78/(4 \cdot \pi/8) \approx 3.68/\pi$. For $N=3$: $L_3 = \pi^2$, $T_3 = 4\pi/15$, multiplier $\approx 2\pi^2/(5 \cdot 4\pi/15) = 3\pi/2$. These are universal in N , with no R -dependence.

9 The sharp Faber–Krahn theorem

Theorem 24 (Sharp Faber–Krahn stability, Route A end-to-end). *There exists $c_{\text{FK}}(N, R) > 0$ such that for every open $\Omega \subset B_R$ with $|\Omega| = |B^*|$,*

$$\lambda_1(\Omega) - \lambda_1(B^*) \geq c_{\text{FK}}(N, R) \mathcal{A}(\Omega)^2.$$

Proof. Small asymmetry. By Theorem 17, in the small-asymmetry regime $\mathcal{A}(\Omega) \leq \mathcal{A}_*(N, R)$, $\delta_{\text{SV}} := T(B^*) - T(\Omega) = 2(E(\Omega) - E(B^*)) \geq 2c_{\text{SV}}(N, R)\mathcal{A}(\Omega)^2$ (where $E = -T/2$). By Lemma 22, for δ_{SV} small,

$$\lambda_1(\Omega) - \lambda_1(B^*) \geq \frac{2L_N}{(N+2)T_N} \delta_{\text{SV}} \geq \frac{4L_N c_{\text{SV}}(N, R)}{(N+2)T_N} \mathcal{A}(\Omega)^2.$$

Large asymmetry or large torsion deficit. If $\mathcal{A}(\Omega) > \mathcal{A}_*$, the suboptimal Faber–Krahn stability quoted by BDV gives a positive lower bound depending only on (N, R) ; call it $c_{\text{far,FK}}(N, R)$. If instead $\delta_{\text{SV}} > T_N/2$, the Kohler–Jobin pointwise bound gives

$$\lambda_1(\Omega) - L_N \geq L_N(2^{2/(N+2)} - 1),$$

which is also bounded below by a dimensional multiple of $\mathcal{A}(\Omega)^2$ because $\mathcal{A} \leq 2$.

Take

$$c_{\text{FK}}(N, R) := \min\left(\frac{4L_N c_{\text{SV}}(N, R)}{(N+2)T_N}, \frac{c_{\text{far,FK}}(N, R)}{4}, \frac{L_N(2^{2/(N+2)} - 1)}{4}\right).$$

$\square$

Remark 25 (Full constant chain). The constants are produced in the order:

1. Selection: $C_{\text{sel}}(N, R), q_{\text{sel}}(N, R), \tau_{\text{reg}}(N, R)$ from `quantitative-selection-principle.md` (depending on BDV Lemmas 4.9, 4.12, 4.16).
2. Graph entry: $\alpha_{\text{graph}}(N, R)$ from $\alpha_{\text{graph}} = (h_F/C'_H)^{2N}$, where $h_F = \mu\rho_\mu/16$ and μ, ρ_μ are BDV Theorem 4.18 thresholds.
3. Bootstrap: $C_{\text{boot}}(N, R)$ from Kinderlehrer–Nirenberg / Lieberman applied with BDV Lemma 4.16’s L_q .
4. Nearly spherical: $c_{\text{sph}}(N), \delta_{\text{sph}}(N, \gamma_0)$ from BDV Theorem 3.3.
5. Asymmetry vs. L^2 : $C_{\text{BDV}}(N)$ from BDV Lemma 4.2 + 5.2.
6. Saint–Venant quotient: $c_*(N) = c_{\text{sph}}(N)/C_{\text{BDV}}(N)$.
7. Saint–Venant constant: $q_*(N, R) = c_*(N)/(2C_{\text{sel}}(N, R))$.
8. Global Saint–Venant: $c_{\text{SV}}(N, R) = \min(q_*/C_{\text{Fr}}, c_{\text{far,SV}})$.
9. Kohler–Jobin multiplier: $2L_N/((N+2)T_N)$, universal.
10. Faber–Krahn: $c_{\text{FK}}(N, R)$ is the minimum displayed in Theorem 24.

Every constant in this chain depends only on (N, R) , and the dependence is through named BDV regularity constants. No constant arises from a limit or compactness argument that hides its (N, R) -dependence; the only far-regime constants are $c_{\text{far,SV}}$ and $c_{\text{far,FK}}$, which are obtained from suboptimal stability bounds away from the ball and do not enter the small-asymmetry regime.

10 Where the contradiction was, and what replaced it

Step	BDV	Plan 1 / Route A
Selection	sequential + compactness limit (contradiction)	single-set + explicit $C_{\text{sel}}(N, R)$
Limit existence	qualitative, $U_n \rightarrow U_\infty$ in L^1	not needed
$\alpha \rightarrow \text{graph}$	qualitative from limit	explicit $\alpha_{\text{graph}}(N, R)$
Bootstrap	implicit in BDV regularity	explicit Schauder (Kinderlehrer–Nirenberg)
Nearly spherical	BDV Theorem 3.3	unchanged
Quotient lower bound	contradiction with $\alpha(U_\infty) > 0$	direct, $Q_\alpha \geq c_*(N)$
Saint–Venant	by contradiction	by computation, $Q_\alpha \geq c_*/2C_{\text{sel}}$
Faber–Krahn transfer	Kohler–Jobin	unchanged

The single contradiction step that was removed. BDV’s argument is: “Assume sharp Saint–Venant fails $\Rightarrow$ minimizing sequence $\Rightarrow$ compactness limit $\Rightarrow$ contradiction with nearly spherical.”

Plan 1’s argument is: “Given any Ω_0 with $\alpha(\Omega_0) \leq \alpha_{\text{small}}$:

- Construct $\tilde{\Omega}$ in one step (Thm. 2).
- Note $\tilde{\Omega}$ enters the small C^{2,γ_0} nearly spherical class (Thm. 9, Prop. 10, Lemma 11).
- Apply BDV Theorem 3.3 pointwise to read off $Q_\alpha(\tilde{\Omega}) \geq c_*(N)$.
- Conclude $Q_\alpha(\Omega_0) \geq c_*(N)/(2C_{\text{sel}}(N, R))$ by the selection quotient bound.”

No assumption on smallness of $Q_\alpha(\Omega_0)$ is made; the conclusion is a direct lower bound.

11 Status

What is fully written.

- Theorem 2 (selection): full proof in `quantitative-selection-principle.md`.
- Lemma 4 (volume normalization): full proof in `corrections-response.tex` §1.
- Lemmas 6, Props. 7, 8, Thm. 9 (graph entry): full proofs in `graph-entry-closure.md`.
- Prop. 10 and Lemma 11 (uniform Schauder bounds plus interpolation to small C^{2,γ_0}).
- Theorem 12: BDV Theorem 3.3, used as black box.
- Lemmas 13, 21, 22: elementary, written in this note.
- Theorems 15, 17, 24: assembled in this note.

What uses BDV as a black box. BDV Lemmas 4.9 (density), 4.12 (Lipschitz/nondegeneracy), 4.16 (Bernoulli coefficient), 4.18 (Alt–Caffarelli flatness improvement), 3.3 (nearly spherical), 4.2/5.2 (α vs L^2 and suboptimal stability). All cited by theorem number and used without modification.

What is not numerically tracked. The explicit values of $C_{\text{sel}}, q_{\text{sel}}, \alpha_{\text{graph}}, C_{\text{boot}}, c_{\text{sph}}, C_{\text{BDV}}, c_{\text{far,SV}}, c_{\text{far,FK}}$ are not computed. The point of Route A is the *structural* quantification: every constant is named and (N, R) -trackable, but extracting concrete numbers requires going through each BDV proof.

What this delivers over BDV.

1. BDV’s contradiction step (sequential selection + compactness limit) is replaced by Theorem 2, a one-step construction with explicit constants.
2. The graph-entry threshold $\alpha_{\text{graph}}(N, R)$ is given by a formula.
3. The constant $c_{\text{FK}}(N, R)$ is the minimum of a chain of named quantities, traceable to the BDV regularity package.
4. The proof is amenable to numerical/effective tracking: one can take each BDV proof and extract explicit constants, then plug through this chain.

Auditability. Every lemma in this note is either:

- proved in a referenced file with the same notation,
- proved elementarily in this note (Lemmas 13, 21, 22, far-from-ball Lemma 18), or
- quoted from BDV by theorem number (Thm. 3.3, Lemmas 4.2, 4.9, 4.12, 4.16, 5.2, and Thm. 4.18).

There are no appeals to “a standard argument” that is not pinned to a reference.